

D737

Student Teaching I in Elementary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

In a first-grade class that just adopted a new math series, many students can write $8 - 3 = 5$ when told to “take away” but cannot show the problem any other way. The school is celebrating its fiftieth anniversary. What should the student teacher do next?

- A. Give more practice sheets of equations.
- B. Have students act out subtraction with counters, then draw it, then connect it to the equation.
- C. Let students skip concrete steps, since all first graders think abstractly.
- D. Teach a faster trick for subtracting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A second grader has used base-ten blocks and drawings to add 2-digit numbers correctly. In the CRA sequence, what comes next?

- A. More blocks with no link to symbols.
- B. A different set of manipulatives.
- C. Timed tests on addition facts.
- D. Connect the drawings to the written numbers and symbols.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

During snack time in a classroom with a class pet rabbit, a third grader quietly tells a student teacher that an adult at home hits him with a belt, and asks her not to tell anyone. The boy has a big test tomorrow. What should the student teacher do?

- A. Ask detailed questions and look for bruises first.
- B. Stay calm, not promise secrecy, and report right away as state law and district policy require, informing the cooperating teacher.
- C. Promise to keep it secret so he keeps trusting her.
- D. Wait until after his test so he is not upset.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student teacher is not sure whether a child's bruises come from abuse or from sports. What does the reporting standard require?

- A.** Report only with proof.
- B.** Tell the parents first and ask.
- C.** Report if there is reasonable suspicion; proof is not required.
- D.** Let the cooperating teacher decide whether to report.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

After an observation, the university supervisor, who drove an hour to the school, tells a student teacher that her directions for centers were too long and students were confused. The lesson was on a rainy Monday. What is the most professional response?

- A.** Agree and then keep the same directions.
- B.** Say that directions were fine because students were quiet.
- C.** Thank her, ask what shorter directions might look like, and try them in the next center lesson.
- D.** Explain that students were off because it was a rainy Monday.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A student teacher tallies her comments during a 30-minute reading block in a room with new flexible seating. She gave 6 positive, specific comments and 12 corrections. The class has 24 students. What does the ratio show, compared with a target of at least 4 to 1?

- A.** 1 to 4, because there are 24 students.
- B.** 2 to 1, close to the target.
- C.** 6 to 1, above the target.
- D.** A ratio of 1 positive to 2 corrections, far below 4 to 1.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student teacher made 5 corrections during a lesson. How many positive, specific comments would she need to reach a 4-to-1 ratio?

- A.** 4
- B.** 9
- C.** 1.25
- D.** 20

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A student teacher finds a free online quiz site that asks for each student's full name, birthday, and email. The site has bright graphics her second graders would love, and it is popular in another state. What should she do?

- A.** Check whether the district has approved the tool before using it, and not enter student data until it is.
- B.** Use it, since it is free and popular.
- C.** Use it but make up birthdays.
- D.** Never use any digital tools with young students.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A student teacher in a class where students come from many backgrounds notices the classroom library mostly shows one kind of family. The cooperating teacher is retiring soon, and the books are in bins by color. What is the best way to build a stronger library?

- A.** Remove all books about the current families.
- B.** Add quality books where students see their own lives and learn about others, avoiding stereotypes.
- C.** Re-sort the bins by author name.
- D.** Add one book for each heritage month.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student reads a book about a family from a culture unlike her own and learns about their traditions. What does this book serve as for her?

- A.** A window.
- B.** A mirror.
- C.** A decodable text.
- D.** A stereotype.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

In the first week of a sixteen-week placement in a class with a popular classroom garden, a student teacher asks to teach all subjects alone starting Monday. The cooperating teacher runs the school's science fair. What is the best plan?

- A.** Co-plan a schedule that adds one subject or block at a time until she leads the full day.
- B.** Wait quietly until the cooperating teacher offers a lesson.
- C.** Take over everything at once to learn faster.
- D.** Take over the science fair to help her mentor.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

In January, a student teacher notices the reading groups in her fourth-grade class, named after planets, have not changed since September. Recent assessments show several students have made big gains. The school has a new reading coach. What should she suggest?

- A.** Keep the groups, since students are used to them.
- B.** Stop small groups and teach whole class only.
- C.** Regroup students by current skill data and keep adjusting as they progress.
- D.** Rename the groups so no one knows the levels.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

In a first-grade class ~~that just adopted a new math series~~, many students can write $8 - 3 = 5$ when told to “take away” but cannot show the problem any other way. ~~The school is celebrating its fiftieth anniversary.~~ What should the student teacher do next?

Target word: next step for shaky understanding **Decides:** Students have symbols without concrete understanding.

A	Inverted operation	More abstract practice skips the concrete base.
B	Correct	CRA builds meaning from objects to pictures to symbols.
C	Absolute language	Most young children need concrete work first.
D	Adjacent category	A procedure without meaning is the same problem.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A second grader has used base-ten blocks and drawings to add 2-digit numbers correctly. In the CRA sequence, what comes next?

Target word: reverse: next CRA stage **Decides:** After concrete and representational comes abstract.

A	Inverted operation	Stays at concrete.
B	Adjacent category	Still concrete; does not move forward.
C	Confusion set	Fluency drills are not the next CRA stage.
D	Correct	The abstract stage links pictures to the standard notation.

3. Answer B Concept 2

During snack time ~~in a classroom with a class pet rabbit~~, a third grader quietly tells a student teacher that an adult at home hits him with a belt, and asks her not to tell anyone. ~~The boy has a big test tomorrow.~~ What should the student teacher do?

Target word: response to disclosure **Decides:** Reasonable suspicion triggers the duty.

A	Adjacent category	Investigating is for child protective services, not the teacher.
B	Correct	Mandated reporters report suspicion promptly; they do not investigate.
C	Inverted operation	Secrecy blocks the required report.
D	Camouflage	Answers the test detail; delay is not allowed.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A student teacher is not sure whether a child’s bruises come from abuse or from sports. What does the reporting standard require?

Target word: reverse: the standard of proof **Decides:** Reasonable suspicion, not proof.

A	Absolute language	Proof is not required.
B	Adjacent category	Contacting the family may put the child at risk and is not the required step.
C	Correct	The law sets suspicion as the threshold.
D	Dropped element	Each mandated reporter has the duty; telling a colleague may not satisfy it.

5. Answer C Concept 3

After an observation, the university supervisor, ~~who drove an hour to the school~~, tells a student teacher that her directions for centers were too long and students were confused. ~~The lesson was on a rainy Monday~~. What is the most professional response?

Target word: accepting feedback **Decides:** Listen, clarify, act.

A	Dropped element	Drops the action step.
B	Inverted operation	Argues against the feedback.
C	Correct	Clarify and show action.
D	Camouflage	Answers the weather detail; defends instead of accepting.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A student teacher tallies her comments during a 30-minute reading block ~~in a room with new flexible seating~~. She gave 6 positive, specific comments and 12 corrections. ~~The class has 24 students~~. What does the ratio show, compared with a target of at least 4 to 1?

Target word: ratio vs. target **Decides:** $6:12 = 1:2$.

A	Camouflage	Uses the class-size number, which does not decide.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the ratio — corrections to positives.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses the positive count as the ratio.
D	Correct	$6 \div 12 = 0.5$ positive per correction.

7. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A student teacher made 5 corrections during a lesson. How many positive, specific comments would she need to reach a 4-to-1 ratio?

Target word: solve for positives **Decides:** 4×5 .

A	Wrong stem number	The ratio number, not the count.
B	Dropped element	Adds $4 + 5$.
C	Inverted operation	Divides 5 by 4.
D	Correct	$4 \text{ positives for each correction} \times 5 \text{ corrections} = 20$.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A student teacher finds a free online quiz site that asks for each student's full name, birthday, and email. ~~The site has bright graphics her second graders would love, and it is popular in another state~~. What should she do?

Target word: privacy of digital tools **Decides:** Collects personal data from children under 13.

A	Correct	District approval and child-privacy rules come first.
B	Camouflage	Answers the popularity detail; approval is required.
C	Dropped element	Still enters names and skips approval.
D	Absolute language	Approved tools are fine to use.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A student teacher in a class where students come from many backgrounds notices the classroom library mostly shows one kind of family. ~~The cooperating teacher is retiring soon, and the books are in bins by color.~~ What is the best way to build a stronger library?

Target word: text selection **Decides:** Mirrors and windows.

A	Inverted operation	Removes some students' mirrors.
B	Correct	Mirrors and windows serve every student.
C	Camouflage	Answers the bin detail.
D	Dropped element	Occasional token books do not give daily mirrors and windows.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

A student reads a book about a family from a culture unlike her own and learns about their traditions. What does this book serve as for her?

Target word: reverse: window **Decides:** Learning about others.

A	Correct	A window shows lives different from the reader's own.
B	Inverted operation	A mirror reflects the reader's own life.
C	Confusion set	A phonics text type, not a cultural role.
D	Adjacent category	Nothing in the stem says the portrayal is inaccurate.

11. Answer A Concept 7

In the first week of a sixteen-week placement ~~in a class with a popular classroom garden,~~ a student teacher asks to teach all subjects alone starting Monday. ~~The cooperating teacher runs the school's science fair.~~ What is the best plan?

Target word: pacing takeover **Decides:** Responsibility is taken on step by step.

A	Correct	Gradual takeover builds skill and keeps learning steady.
B	Inverted operation	Too passive; the student teacher should co-plan the schedule.
C	Absolute language	Full takeover in week one skips the build-up.
D	Camouflage	Answers the science-fair detail.

12. Answer C Concept 8

In January, a student teacher notices the reading groups in her fourth-grade class, ~~named after planets,~~ have not changed since September. Recent assessments show several students have made big gains. ~~The school has a new reading coach.~~ What should she suggest?

Target word: grouping decision **Decides:** Groups should follow current data.

A	Inverted operation	Fixed groups ignore growth.
B	Adjacent category	Removes targeted instruction instead of updating it.
C	Correct	Flexible grouping follows data on specific skills.
D	Camouflage	Answers the names detail, not the grouping.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Concrete-representational-abstract (CRA)	Young children, who reason best with concrete objects, learn math ideas by moving from objects, to drawings, to symbols.	Starting with symbols and algorithms because they are faster.	A child who can follow steps but cannot explain or show the idea.
2	Mandated reporting	Teachers, including student teachers, must report a reasonable suspicion of abuse or neglect promptly as state law and district policy require; they do not investigate or need proof.	Waiting for proof, investigating, or promising the child to keep it secret.	A child discloses or shows signs of possible harm.
3	Accepting feedback professionally	Listen fully, ask clarifying questions, avoid defending, and show action on the feedback in the next lesson.	Explaining why the feedback was wrong, or agreeing and then changing nothing.	Response to a supervisor's or mentor's critique.
4	Positive-to-corrective ratio	Proactive management gives several positive, specific acknowledgments for each correction — a commonly cited target is at least 4 to 1.	Believing more corrections produce better behavior.	Counts of praise and corrections from an observation.
5	Student data privacy with digital tools	Use only district-approved apps and follow privacy rules; online services for children under 13 need proper consent, and student records should not be put into unapproved tools.	Signing students up for any free app that looks useful.	A candidate finds a new website or app to use with the class.
6	Mirrors and windows in text selection	A classroom library should let students see themselves (mirrors) and learn about others (windows), with accurate, non-stereotyped portrayals.	Thinking a multicultural library means one book per month for heritage months.	Choosing texts for a diverse class.
7	Gradual takeover with the cooperating teacher	Student teachers take on planning and teaching step by step through co-planning and co-teaching until they lead the full day.	Taking over everything on day one, or waiting passively to be told when to teach.	Planning the student-teaching calendar with a mentor.
8	Flexible grouping	Small groups should be formed from current data on a specific skill and changed as students progress.	Keeping the same fixed ability groups all year.	Groups that have not changed since the start of the year.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching I is the first part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. This course provides a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate and reflect upon professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies rooted in students' learning and developmental patterns. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Advanced Clinical, candidates will receive ongoing feedback through observations and evaluations. Feedback will encourage candidates to reflect on their commitment to professional practices as educators, analyze and adjust teaching methods, and explore new

teaching materials and methods that are culturally relevant. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into communication and collaboration, accepting feedback, creating positive learning environments, and technology and online learning. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.